

THE MOTION

This Club Believes that

Respecting personal autonomy requires society to tolerate self destructive choices

MARK WHERE YOU STAND, NOW AND ON THE WAY OUT STEP IN ☐ ☐ ☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☐ LEAVE THEM TO IT

WHAT THE WORDS MEAN

PERSONAL AUTONOMY

A competent adult's capacity to make informed, voluntary decisions about their own life, by their own values, with nobody coercing them.

SELF DESTRUCTIVE CHOICES

Decisions that risk serious physical, psychological, financial or social harm, mainly to the person making them. Refusing treatment, addiction, gambling, extreme sport, assisted dying.

TOLERATE

To refrain from prohibiting, preventing or punishing a choice you disagree with. Not the same as approving of it: the motion asks whether society should allow, not whether it should applaud.

THE REAL DISAGREEMENT

BOTH SIDES AGREE

Autonomy matters, and society has some duty to prevent serious harm. Neither side denies either, and both accept that some limits on choice are already justified.

THEY SPLIT ON

Is stopping someone from seriously harming themselves a legitimate exercise of social responsibility, or an unjustified exercise of control over their life?

WHERE EACH SIDE STARTS

FOR THE MOTION

An adult who knowingly chooses something that harms mainly themselves should be left to it, however unwise the choice looks from outside.

AGAINST

Autonomy is not absolute. Where the harm is severe or irreversible, or consent is compromised, society may legitimately restrict the choice.

YOUR CASE

Four or five points, one line each, in your own words. On stage you take them one at a time and elaborate, so write the trigger and not the speech.

1

BECAUSE

2

BECAUSE

3

BECAUSE

4

BECAUSE

5

BECAUSE

HOW TO DO THIS

BEFORE YOU SPEAK

Write your four or five strongest points on the front, one line each. Not a speech, just what will remind you of one.

ON STAGE

Take them one at a time and elaborate. A couple of minutes, so roughly thirty seconds a point.

IN THE REBUTTAL

Write down the claim the other side actually made, then answer that one, not the one you wish they had made.

THE ORDER

ROUND ONE

1 Speech, for

2 Speech, against

3 Rebuttals

4 Open floor

ROUND TWO

5 Speech, for

6 Speech, against

7 Rebuttals

8 Open floor

The room votes before the first speech and again after the last. Anyone may take an open floor, drawn or not.

WHILE THEY SPEAK

One row, one exchange. Their claim on the left, your answer on the right.

THEY SAID

MY ANSWER

ROUND ONE

1

2

3

ROUND TWO

4

5

6

THE ONE SENTENCE

The last thing you say is the thing the room votes on. Write it before you stand up.